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Specification of the controlled designation of origin "VIRÉ-CLESSÉ"

approved by decree no. 2011-1794 of 5 December 2011, amended by the order of 26 April 2018
published in the Official Journal of 3 May 2018

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Viré-Clessé", initially recognised by the decree of 26 February 1999.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit known locally as a "climat", provided that:

- it is the name of a registered lieu-dit (cadastral locality);

- it appears on the harvest declaration;

- the wines meet the production conditions laid down for the indication of a smaller geographical unit in the present specification.

2° – The name of the controlled designation of origin, whether or not followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit, must be supplemented by the term "Levrouté" for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for this term in the present specification.

3° – The name of the controlled designation of origin, whether or not followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit, must be supplemented by the term "demi-sec" for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for this term in the present specification.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Viré-Clessé" is reserved for still white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

All stages of production (harvesting of the grapes, vinification, elaboration and ageing of the wines) take place within the geographical area approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 4 and 5 November 1998. On the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, the perimeter of this area covers the territory of the following communes of the Saône-et-Loire department, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2016: Clessé, Laizé, Montbellet and Viré.

The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the website of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from grapes harvested within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 4 and 5 November 1998.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

a) – The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambœuf, Chambolle-Musigny, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Clémencey, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay, Vosne-Romanée and Vougeot;

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Bois-d'Oingt, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Jarnioux, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Légny, Létra, Liergues, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Odenas, Oingt, Les Olmes, Le Perréon, Pommiers, Pouilly-le-Monial, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-Nuelles, Saint-Jean-d'Ardières, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Laurent-d'Oingt, Saint-Loup, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Sainte-Paule, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux and Villié-Morgon;

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-les-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-National, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy-lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fragnes-La-Loyère (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former commune of La Loyère), Fuissé, Genouilly,

Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, Lacrost, Laives, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse and Vinzelles;

- Yonne department: Accolay, Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serein, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Champvallon, Chamvres, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cravant, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerrois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein, Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Saint-Père, Sainte-Pallaye, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villiers-sur-Tholon, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers, Volgré and Yrouerre.

b) – For wines eligible for the term "Levrouté", the immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Saône-et-Loire department: Ameugny, Azé, Berzé-la-ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Blanot, Bonnay, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Chaintré, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Chânes, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Chasselas, Château, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Crèches-sur-Saône, Cruzille, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Donzy-le-National, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Fleurville, Fuissé, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jugy, Lacrost, Laives, Leynes, Lournand, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massy, Milly-Lamartine, Montceaux-Ragny, Nanton, Ozenay, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, La Roche-Vineuse, Royer, Saint-Albain, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Tournus, Uchizy, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse and Vinzelles.

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come solely from the chardonnay B variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

The vines have a minimum planting density of 7,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.40 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row greater than or equal to 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

PRUNING METHOD	**PRUNING RULES**
GENERAL PROVISIONS	
Short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon)	– The vines are pruned with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant; – Each plant bears a maximum of 5 spurs, each pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes.
Long pruning (vines pruned in Guyot or in "taille à queue du Mâconnais")	Vines pruned in single or double Guyot are pruned with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant. Each plant bears: – either a single cane bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes and 2 spurs each pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes; – or a single cane bearing a maximum of 8 free eyes and 1 spur pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes; – or two canes bearing a maximum of 4 free eyes and 1 spur pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes. Vines pruned in "taille à queue du Mâconnais" are pruned with a maximum of 14 free eyes per plant. Each plant bears a cane with a maximum of 12 free eyes, whose tip is tied to the lower trellising wire.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
When cordons are rejuvenated, the vines are pruned with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant. Long pruning may be adapted with a 2nd spur allowing the position of the cane to be alternated from one year to the next. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.	

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The vines must be trellised and the trellising is maintained;

- The height of trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 10,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

- Permanent grass cover of the headlands is compulsory;

- Any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the structuring elements of the landscape of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works;

- If spontaneous vegetation is controlled by chemical weeding, either a plant cover, spontaneous or sown, or a soil covering (mulching, mulch…) is compulsory over at least 20 % of the area between 2 rows.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment or any other method making it possible to combat flavescence dorée.

c) – From 31 July 2009, for any new planting of a parcel:

- either the operator gives preference to plants from mass selection;

- or the operator carries out the planting with plants from clonal selection, in which case the planting is carried out with plants from 3 different clones.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions

Wines eligible for the term "Levrouté" come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

- The harvest is transported to the vinification cellar in containers with a maximum capacity of 3 tonnes;

- The harvest is protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, SMALLER GEOGRAPHICAL UNIT, TERM	**MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)**	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
AOC "Viré-Clessé"	187	11.5 %
AOC "Viré-Clessé" followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit	195	12 %
AOC "Viré-Clessé" supplemented by the term "Levrouté"	246	15 %

b) – Minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume

Wines eligible for the term "Levrouté" have, after fermentation, a minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume of 14 %.

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield and limit yield

The yield and limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are set at:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, SMALLER GEOGRAPHICAL UNIT, TERM	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)	LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)
AOC "Viré-Clessé"	64	70
AOC "Viré-Clessé" followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit	62	68
AOC "Viré-Clessé" supplemented by the term "Levrouté"	48	52

2° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any variety other than that permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the variety permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Analytical standards

Finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, have the following fermentable sugar contents (glucose + fructose):

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	FERMENTABLE SUGAR CONTENT (glucose and fructose)
AOC "Viré-Clessé"	– Less than or equal to 3 grams per litre; – or less than or equal to 4 grams per litre if the total acidity is greater than or equal to 55.10 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 4.13 grams per litre expressed as tartaric acid (or 2.7 grams per litre expressed as H2SO4).
AOC "Viré-Clessé" ("demi-sec" wine)	More than 4 grams per litre and less than 8 grams per litre

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	**FERMENTABLE SUGAR CONTENT (glucose and fructose)**
AOC "Viré-Clessé" supplemented by the term "Levrouté"	8 grams per litre or more and less than or equal to 18 grams per litre

b) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- Demi-sec wines and wines eligible for the term "Levrouté" are not enriched;

- After enrichment, the wines have a total alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 13.5 %.

c) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

d) – Vat capacity

Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration.

e) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar and the vinification equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed; waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

f) – Ageing

GENERAL PROVISION	
The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.	
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
AOC "Viré-Clessé"	The wines are aged at least until 1 February of the year following that of the harvest.
AOC "Viré-Clessé" followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit	The wines are aged at least until 1 April of the year following that of the harvest.
AOC "Viré-Clessé" supplemented by the term "Levrouté"	The wines are aged at least until 1 February of the second year following that of the harvest.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before packaging.

These analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for wines packaged in unlabelled bottles, with a temperature of between 5 °C and 22 °C.

4° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, SMALLER GEOGRAPHICAL UNIT	**DATE**
AOC "Viré-Clessé"	From 15 February of the year following that of the harvest
AOC "Viré-Clessé" followed by the name of a smaller geographical unit	From 15 April of the year following that of the harvest
AOC "Viré-Clessé" supplemented by the term "Levrouté"	From 15 February of the second year following that of the harvest

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area lies within the natural region of the "Monts du Mâconnais", in the southern part of the Burgundy region. It extends over the east-facing slope of one of the easternmost ridges of the "Monts du Mâconnais".

This "ridge", a tilted tectonic structure stretching in a north–south direction parallel to the Bresse rift, exposes the whole Jurassic sedimentary sequence, made up of limestones of varying resistance to erosion and softer marls (clayey limestones). The result is a diversity of substrata, marked in the landscape by a series of parallel ridges on limestone subsoil, separated by elongated depressions on a marly substratum.

The geographical area thus covers the territory of 4 communes of the Saône-et-Loire department, about ten kilometres north-west of the town of Mâcon.

The parcels precisely delimited for the harvesting of the grapes are planted on hillsides, on the limestone and marl substrata. They lie on two parallel north–south "côtes", at altitudes of between 200 metres and 440 metres, one on Middle Jurassic limestones, the other on Upper Jurassic marl-limestone substrata. The rock is frequently masked by surface formations, sometimes decarbonated, represented by clays with "chailles" (flint-like nodules) on the shelves of the main "côte", or by clayey silts on the piedmont and on the marl-limestone formations.

The whole is bounded to the north and south by two substantial valleys that interrupt the ridge (the Bourbonne and the Mouge) and is homogeneous both topographically and climatically.

The soils, developed both on the limestones and on the surface formations, are always well drained. Depending on the subsoil, they may be very carbonated and stony on the limestones, more or less calcic, and sometimes clayey and deep on the surface formations.

The geographical area enjoys a modified oceanic climate with clear southern influences. Annual rainfall, evenly distributed over the year, is less than 800 millimetres and is moderate during the vine's growing season. The geographical area is partly protected from wet oceanic influences by the Mâconnais ridges and benefits, from the first fine days and through the proximity of the Saône valley, from mild southern air currents rising along the Rhône corridor. The average annual temperature is 11 °C. The summer heat often lasts into the autumn.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Vine plantings in the Saône valley, and notably in the Mâconnais, date from the 3rd century AD. However, the first writings mentioning dues levied on wines produced in the communes of Viré and Clessé appear only in the 7th century, in the cartularies of the abbey of Cluny and of the chapter of the cathedral of Saint-Vincent de Mâcon. "Viriaco", the medieval name of Viré, is said to mean "vine growing", pointing to the ancient character of its wine-growing tradition.

The history of the villages of Viré and Clessé has always been linked, as shown by the lieu-dit "Quintaine", which straddles the territory of the two communes. This lieu-dit is a former parish that was annexed in turn to Viré and to Clessé by the nobles and ecclesiastical establishments that shared the territory until the 18th century.

The rehabilitation of the vineyard of these communes after the phylloxera crisis was rapid. VERMOREL and DANGUY reported in 1894 that on the Chapitre estate "the Dubuc family, in 1888, planted four fifths with chardonnay […] it now supplies the best wines of Viré". Plantings of the chardonnay B variety intensified, and this variety represented 70 % of the planting in 1970 and 100 % twenty years later. A local cultivar of this variety, "muscaté", was also planted, and a few plants still survived in some parcels in 2010.

The wines produced in the 2 communes of Viré and Clessé were first recognised within the controlled designation of origin "Mâcon" in 1937. However, the professionals of these 2 communes were always convinced that they had a territory and know-how capable of stamping their mark on the originality of their white wine production. By seeking the best match between the variety and its planting sites, by adapting pruning and vine-training techniques as well as possible, by harvesting at optimal ripeness, and by making technical improvements in temperature control and the ageing of the wines, these producers obtained recognition of the controlled designation of origin "Viré-Clessé" on 26 February 1999.

The chardonnay B variety is traditionally pruned with a double arch, a pruning technique called "taille à queue du Mâconnais", which is practised on old vines but has been supplanted in young plantings by single-arch pruning, or even single Guyot, in order to control ripeness and yield as well as possible.

Covering about 400 hectares, for an annual production of more than 20,000 hectolitres, the vineyard is worked by about 250 operators. The wines are marketed by 50 private cellars and 25 négociants, but a large share of production is sold by the 2 historic cooperative cellars, created in 1927 (Clessé) and 1928 (Viré).

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The dry white wine has a green-gold robe and offers a complex aromatic expression that frequently reveals aromas of white and yellow flowers accompanied by mineral notes. It is characterised by finesse, suppleness and frankness, very often enhanced by notes of dried fruit, with a fine presence and long persistence on the palate. It keeps its qualities after a few years of ageing, up to 10 years and more.

The demi-sec wine has a green-gold robe with golden highlights and offers characteristics similar to the aromatic expression of the dry white wines, such as white flowers, with which notes of candied fruit, dried fruit and exotic fruit may be associated.

A few sectors within the delimited parcel area have a natural aptitude favourable to the overripening of the grapes and to their harvest after the action of botrytis cinerea. Grapes from these sectors, when affected by "noble rot", are known locally as "levroûtés" because the colour of their skin recalls the "coat of the hare". Emile VIOLLET (1877-1964), a writer and historian of the region, reported the existence of wines from "levroûtée" harvests with a fermentable sugar content of several tens of grams per litre, notably in the commune of Clessé, well before the phylloxera crisis.

Over time, however, the local use of the term "levrouté" extended to designate wines with a higher fermentable sugar content than dry wines, including when the harvest was not affected by "noble rot".

The "Levrouté" wine has a yellow-gold robe with an aromatic expression revealing aromas of ripe and candied fruit with honeyed notes combined with floral aromas. The "Levrouté" wine is a balanced wine owing to its suppleness, its finesse and its tangy notes, giving it fine persistence on the palate.

3° – Causal interactions

Reflecting usage, the parcel area delimited for the harvesting of the grapes favours parcels situated on the flanks of hillsides facing the rising sun, at altitudes of between 200 metres and 440 metres, with soils having a good water regime thanks to the presence of a limestone substratum. These situations, linked to the particular mesoclimate of the geographical area, favour optimal ripeness of the grapes and early phenolic ripeness while maintaining a high level of acidity, which balances the final roundness of the wines and ensures them good ageing potential.

These situations are moreover particularly favourable to the chardonnay B variety, which has established itself with producers over the generations. They nevertheless require rigorous management of the plant and its production potential, reflected in the specification by the training of the vine, precise pruning rules, controlled yields, cultivation practices ensuring the preservation of the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, and a selective choice of plant material.

This management illustrates the know-how of operators attached to their wine landscape. This know-how is also reflected in the ability of the winemaker, acquired from the experience of several generations, to express the richness and originality of the natural environment. Thus, while most production consists of dry wines, the operators' know-how in observing the particular climatic conditions of a year, the expression of the characteristics of the environment and the physiology of the vine allows them to make the most of a parcel's aptitude to produce overripe grapes, which will give "Levrouté" wines with a higher fermentable sugar content than dry wines.

The wines of "Viré-Clessé" are most often presented under the name of a "climat" (name given regionally to a cadastral lieu-dit) in order to distinguish their origin, the most renowned being "Quintaine".

In his "Étude des vignobles", Jules GUYOT, in 1868, presented the wines of "Viré-Clessé" as "always true to themselves, always pleasant, always sound and, moreover, at more than reasonable prices". These characteristics are still found in 2010 and are regularly noted by tasters and consumers. Producers maintain the renown and reputation of the wines of "Viré-Clessé" through their dynamism, their know-how and their historical attachment to the chardonnay B variety.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Planting density

Vine parcels in place on 31 July 2007 with a planting density of between 5,000 and 7,000 plants per hectare continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until

they are grubbed up.

2° – Pruning rules

Vine parcels in place before 31 August 1975 and pruned in the so-called "taille à queue du Mâconnais" may be pruned in such a way that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, each plant bears a maximum of 28 fruit-bearing shoots of the year, including 2 canes each bearing a maximum of 12 fruit-bearing shoots of the year.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Viré-Clessé" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The name of the smaller geographical unit is placed immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The term "Levrouté" is printed in characters whose dimensions are, both in height and in width, at least greater than half of, and not greater than, those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

c) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin, if not supplemented by the terms "Levrouté" or "demi-sec", may specify the larger geographical unit "Vin de Bourgogne" or "Grand Vin de Bourgogne".

d) – Where the grape variety is indicated on the labelling, this indication does not appear in the same field of vision as the compulsory particulars and is printed in characters whose dimensions do not exceed 2 millimetres.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Declaration of intention to produce wines eligible for the term "Levrouté"

Every operator wishing to produce wines eligible for the term "Levrouté" declares its intention each year to the defence and management body by sending a copy of the monitoring register for wines eligible for the term "Levrouté", described in point II.2 of the present chapter, at the latest on 1 November of the year of harvest.

The defence and management body transmits these declarations of intention to produce to the control body as soon as possible.

2. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

3. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

4. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares to the approved control body each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged. It is made within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption or before the lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, making available to the approved control body the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code serves as the declaration of release for consumption, under the conditions set out in the control plan.

5. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

6. Fallback declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month.

This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the lot concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin concerned.

The defence and management body transmits without delay to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin concerned the list of operators who have made a monthly fallback declaration, together with a summary statement indicating:

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage(s);

- the state of the lot(s) concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

7. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration within time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume downgraded;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

8. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of

origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

2. Monitoring register for wines eligible for the term "Levrouté"

Every operator producing wines eligible for the term "Levrouté" keeps up to date a monitoring register indicating for each lot concerned:

- the identification of the lot;

- the year of harvest;

- the cadastral references and areas of the parcels from which the wines come;

- the volume;

- the minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume at harvest;

- the total alcoholic strength by volume of the finished wine;

- the fermentable sugar content of the finished wine.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	– Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; – Check in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density, plant material)	– Documentary check; – Check in the field
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	– Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; – On-site check
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	– Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; – On-site check
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Manual harvesting for wines eligible for the term "Levrouté"	– Documentary check: monitoring register; – Check in the field
Ripeness of the grapes	– Documentary check: records of ripeness monitoring; – Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	– Documentary check: enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; – On-site check
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	– Documentary check (keeping the list up to date); – Check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	– Documentary and on-site check: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; – Check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection) eligible for the term "Levrouté"	Analytical examination of all lots; organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption) eligible for the term "Levrouté"	Analytical examination of all lots; organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

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This control body is accredited in accordance with standard NF EN ISO CEI 17065.

Compliance with the present specification is checked by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, on behalf of the INAO, on the basis of an approved control plan.

The control plan recalls the self-checks carried out by operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. All checks are carried out by sampling. Packaged and non-packaged wines eligible for the term "Levrouté" are subject to systematic analytical checks. Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory are subject to systematic analytical and organoleptic checks.